

That would give me a real interest in life. Most weeks I'd live at the rate of a hundred—but occasionally at the rate of a thousand."

"But the percentage against you on the horses is certainly as bad as in the market," I reminded him.

"Worse," he said cheerfully, "but playing the horses is at least fun."

Perhaps we have time for one more question before Professor Jones takes over this room for his discussion of "Rationalistic Fallacies of Primitive Peoples." . . .

Yes, I'm glad you brought that up. You want to know, if Wall Street is the sort of hit-or-miss place I have described, why it shouldn't be legislated out of existence.

Well, it shouldn't, and I am not being sarcastic. Why not? Well, tell me, what is your business? . . .

You are a plumber? Well then, for your sake—as well as for the sake of countless other persons.

I can name you offhand, sir, a dozen corporations whose products you use in your business, and all those corporations need at least a few million dollars apiece for the kind of plants they run. None of their stuff can be produced by some fellow and his uncle in the back of a garage. Now it may be just unfortunate, but the only successful way so far devised for getting such sums out of the public, for enterprises good or bad, is a system similar to the devious mechanisms of Wall Street. And the system has always included all of the non-sense. (Money has occasionally been raised from the public by smacking the citizens with the broad side of a saber, but the results of this were always less than satisfactory.)

In conclusion, I must remind you that I work in Wall Street and assure you that my organization is quite different from anything I have described here. If you have any knotty investment problems, just stop in at my office and let us recommend a program. I will see to it personally that your inquiries are referred to the head of our crystal-gazing department.